Thwarted and reduced, his sole possession now is only half an ‘amalaka’ (myrobalan). And yet he summons a man to take it to the monks at Kukkutarama, instructing him to say to them that this, his last offering, should be ‘distributed in such a way that it is offered to and enjoyed by the whole community.’ The half-fruit is mashed and put into a soup distributed to the whole community. This happens even as the Elder of the Sangha tells the monks about the nature of the emotions that come into play at the sight of an unhappy emperor shorn of all that distinguished his rule:

> A great donor, the lord of men,
> the eminent Maurya Asoka,
> has gone from being lord of Jambudvipa
> to being lord of half a myrobalan.
> Today this lord of the earth,
> his sovereignty stolen by his servants
> presents the gift of just half a myrobalan,
> as though reproving the common folk
> whose hearts are puffed up
> with a passion for enjoying great splendour.

The final embellishment given to the image of Ashoka is that of Supreme Donor. On the eve of his death, thanks to this last gift, his sovereign powers are restored to him—whereupon the dying emperor promptly proceeds to donate the whole earth to the Sangha, excluding only the state treasury (what the earth was worth minus the state treasury is conjectural). The donation of the earth to the Sangha was inscribed with his teeth. This act of using his teeth to seal a bequest asserted royal authority in the most unambiguous way. The composer of the *Ashokavadana* would no doubt have been surprised had he known that, many centuries later in England, the gift of lands to Paulyn de Rawdon was said to have been formalized in an identical way by William the Conqueror: